

Redemption

A One-Round Shadowrun Virtual Seattle Adventure

by Scott Spencer and William Redd

The runners must make an investigation into the mind of a serial killer and come back again.

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This is a RPGA Network adventure game. A four-hour time block has been allocated for playing the game (or this round of the game), but the actual playing time will be about three hours.

It is a good idea to ask each player to put a name tag in front of him or her. The tag should have the player's name at the bottom, and the character's name, race, and gender at the top. This makes it easier for the players to keep track of who is playing which character.

Scoring the game for RPGA points: The RPGA has three ways to score this game. Consult your convention coordinator to determine which method to use:

1. *No-vote scoring:* The players write their names and numbers on the scoring packet grid, you fill in the top of the grid. That is all. No one is rated. This method is used for people who are just playing for fun.
2. *Partial scoring:* The players rate the game master and the scenario on their player voting sheet, and provide personal information, but don't vote for other players. The game master rates the scenario and completes personal and event information, but does not rate the players as a team or vote for players. This method is used when there is no competition, but the convention coordinator wants information as to how the game masters are performing, or the game master wants feedback on his or her own performance.
3. *Voting:* Players and game masters complete the entire packet, including voting for best player. If this method is used, be sure to allow about 15-20 minutes for the players to briefly describe their characters to the other players, and about 5-10 minutes for voting. This method is used when the players want to know who played the best amongst them, or when the adventure is run in tournament format with winners and prizes. Multi-round adventures usually required advancing a smaller number of players than played the first round, so voting is required for multi-round adventures.

When using Voting, rank the players in order of your voting choice while they are completing their forms, so that you are not influenced by their comments on your abilities.

The players are free to use the game rules to learn about equipment and weapons their characters are carrying.

Some of the text in this scenario is written so that you may present it as written to the players, while other text is for your eyes only. Text for the players will be in ***bold italics***. It is strongly recommended that you paraphrase the player text, instead of reading it aloud, as

some of the text is general and must be adapted to the specific situation or to actions of the player characters.

About This Adventure

This adventure is designed for a group of three to six players using characters generated under the Virtual Seattle guidelines or pre-generated "Primed Runner" characters in *Polyhedron* 107. The adventure is organized into several chapters that the GM will refer to based on the decisions of the party. Karma refreshes after each section. An additional section, **Legwork**, covers information that the runners can learn by using their contacts and investigative skills.

Each section of the adventure is broken down into sub-sections; **Tell It To Them Straight**, **Biz**, and **Details**. **Tell It To Them Straight** contains information to be read to the players when they first enter the encounter. **Biz** is all the information the characters can learn by using skills or poking around. **Details** contain background information for the GM to use when running the encounter.

HOUSEKEEPING

Before the run begins, all players must deduct one month's lifestyle Nuyen from their liquid cash, unless they have purchased a Permanent Lifestyle. If they do not have enough? Tough! They were warned in the character generation rules buy. They must buy a lower lifestyle or live on the street. And the streets ain't a nice place chummer. If they live, maybe they will learn from their mistake.

For each Initiate at the table (above 3rd) roll 1d6 with a target of 10 – the initiate grade. If you roll over the number it means that a particular megacorp has noticed the initiate. They can take steps to deal with him or her.

TEAM KARMA POOL IS EQUAL TO THE NUMBER OF PLAYERS AT THE TABLE.

A Note to GMs: *Redemption* is intended as a murder mystery. It does not follow the usual linear plot of other VS Adventures; rather it is intended to be run in a freeform fashion, until the final scene.

I hope you enjoy running it as much as I did writing it. By the way, feedback would be great, you can email me at java@series2000.com and let me know what you thought of it.

Adventure Summary and Background

Our story begins three weeks before the runners are called. A smuggler, by the name of Hanson, has gotten his hands on a very old painting. The painting is a focus for a very nasty spirit. The Spirit manipulated Hanson into bringing it to Seattle. The smuggler shows up with the painting but his buyer does not show up. Hanson needs to get rid of it quickly so he starts putting out feelers. From stage left enters Jannos Kolchak, a down-on-his-luck artist who happens to hear about this painting. Once he sees it he knows he must own it. Oddly enough, the painting/spirit talks to him. Jannos manages to beg, borrow and steal enough money to meet Hanson's asking price. As soon as he has the painting in his possession, the spirit goes to work on him. It makes Jannos stronger and insanely protective of the painting. In a fit of rage, Jannos snaps the smuggler's neck and cuts off the hands that dared to touch the painting. Jannos takes the painting home to Redmond and starts having conversations with it. The Spirit promises Jannos power, money, glory and best of all, inspiration. Jannos starts to paint again under the guidance of the Spirit. His new paintings are vibrant and rich. He takes the painting to his old mentor from college, Dr. Tonshiko Hana. She is just as enthralled by the painting as Jannos was. It is a lost masterpiece of Van Gogh or Hieronymus Bosch; she wants Jannos to leave it with her for study. Unfortunately for Hana, the spirit does not like that one bit and once again convinces Jannos that she is a threat. It tells him to kill her, making sure to harvest her blood and eyes. This will enhance his painting. By now, Jannos' physical transformation is complete and his mind is firmly in the grasp of the Spirit. Out of the blue, Jannos gets a visit from Abbot Rosenthal, who heard about the painting from Dr. Hana. Jannos cannot resist showing off his new paintings. Rosenthal, who sees only in the astral; immediately recognizes the Spirit for what it is and flees. Threatened, the Spirit sends Jannos to deal with him. Once again Jannos kills and in a fit of rage rips Rosenthal's head off his body. He then harvests the blood and the ears from the mage. After all, blind eyes cannot see the beauty of his painting. At this point, Jannos is ready to show his work. He calls a local gallery and sets up a showing with very little effort. Enter Thomas Kyle, bonded courier for Knight Errant. He has been sent by the gallery to pick up the paintings for exhibit. He enters Jannos' home and takes all of the paintings while Jannos is out looking for his next donor. Jannos returns home to find the painting gone and a receipt from Knight Errant. Desperate to get his painting back, he tracks Thomas to his home and finds

out where the painting is. Thomas does not survive the meeting.

Enter the runners; they receive a phone call from their old friend Jennifer Richardson, the Corp executive cum Werewolf from "By the Light of the Silvery Moon." She wants to hire the players to protect her friend Melina Kyle, as well as investigate and avenge the death of Ms. Kyle's brother, Thomas. It seems that Thomas was murdered in a particularly grisly fashion. His eyes were removed while he was still alive and then he slowly bled to death. During his autopsy, the coroner found that his heart had been removed and a live dove put into its place. As it turns out, this is just one of a string of grisly murders that has been happening lately. What the runners don't know is that both Lone Star and the FBI are very interested in this case; these murders have been going on for a very long time. Often they will catch the killer, but he or she is usually completely catatonic. The killings will then start up again at random intervals. In fact, the FBI is hoping that the killer will make a run at Melina Kyle and thus have her under 24-hour surveillance.

In the meantime; Jannos then goes to the Gallery where the painting is; however, there are lots of people there. The Spirit cautions Jannos to wait until there is no-one around. Jannos makes an appointment with the gallery owner, insisting that it be at 4 in the morning. He then kills the owner, retrieves the painting and destroys what he considers inferior artwork.

As the runners investigate, they will follow the trail of bodies and find that all of the victims were somehow connected by a certain painting, which in turn will lead them to Jannos Kolchak, the newest nova hot artist on the gallery scene.

While the runners are investigating, Jannos is having trouble of his own. One of the local gangs, the Union Jacks, has taken interest in Jannos' activities. They invade his home hoping for a little fun. Jannos dispatches them all, saving their leader for his ritual.

By now, Jannos and the Spirit have learned that a Lone Star Detective, Harry Bosh, is on their trail. The Spirit has a particular hatred for Harry; he managed to stop the Spirit's last host. Archibald von Leech, five years ago. Jannos is instructed to bring Harry Bosh to the house as the last sacrifice in the ritual that will free the Spirit. Jannos complies, with some difficulty. Having brought Bosh to the house; Jannos begins the ritual when the runners arrive. Seeing all of its plans ruined again, the Spirit flees, leaving Jannos to deal with the runners on his own.

A note to GM's this adventure takes place over the course of 5 days. Please remember that some people do not like to be called at 4 in the morning. Make sure the runners get their beauty rest. Otherwise impose

negative modifiers.

Introduction

Tell It To Them Straight: *You check and double-check the address; it's the right one all right. The huge ivy covered manor house on a sweeping estate at the heart of Bellevue. A shadowrunner's nightmare. The Johnson, Jennifer, said be there at 10 pm sharp, and it's 10pm. As you ring the bell, the door swings open on its own, a small floating man greets you [this is a watcher], "Please follow me to the study, you are expected." The apparition leads you down a long hall to an oak door, "Go on, the Mistress is expecting you." As you enter the room, the first thing you note is that the walls are covered in books, real honest-to-drek cloth and paper books. In the center of the room, sitting in front of a large crackling fire, are two women talking in hushed tones. Also in the room, sprawled out right in front of the fire, is a large black wolf looking right at you.*

[If a mage assenses (Intelligence (4)) the room he will notice that the wolf and one of the women are both dual natured--in fact they are werewolves. However, the aura of the woman is different somehow, it does not look natural. The other woman is a mundane, although her aura looks like it has been severed. The mage will also note that there are several watchers hovering around.) (Note: if any character has enhanced hearing they will overhear what seems to be one person consoling the other. Lots of sniffs and sobs, and such.)

As you take a step closer, one of the women stands up--she is a statuesque blond. "Friends, please help yourselves to some refreshments and make yourselves comfortable" she says as she gestures at the wet bar by the door and the chairs arrayed in front of the desk. Once the runners have gotten drinks and/or sat down she will continue. It is good to see some of you again. Some of you I know--some I don't. All are welcome, I am Jennifer Richardson. The wolf is Krom, at which point the wolf walks to the nearest character and starts sniffing. She points to the other woman, "That is Melina Kyle, the reason you are here. (Those runners who have played "By the Light of the Silvery Moon" she will greet by name and seems glad to seem them again. If asked about her "condition" she will smile and just gloss over it.) At this point introductions are in order. Well, I guess we should get down to business...Two days ago, Melina's brother Kyle was savagely murdered. Your job is two-fold; first and foremost, you are to investigate the death of Thomas Kyle and find the killer. Once you have found

him, eliminate him. The second part of the job is to help protect Melina. Krom and I can only do so much; she will be in your care when she leaves the grounds. For these services, I am willing to pay your team a flat fee of 36,000 nuyen and an additional 20,000 for expenses for your team. (At this point let the players negotiate. Jennifer will go as high as 45,000 before she drops the expense account. After that she will go as high as 65,000. Remember that Jennifer is a Renraku troubleshooter as such; negotiation with her will be difficult (7). Her negotiation skill is at 7 as well.) Once the players have agreed, read the following:

Biz

I am glad I can still count on the power of the Nuyen. I suppose you have some questions for Melina. Please be gentle with her, I'm afraid she is still in shock. In fact, it would probably be for the best if you formed your questions now and have one person ask them. I am not sure that Melina is even aware you are here.

Let the players question her however they want to. They should get the impression that Melina is not altogether there. If they get pushy, Melina will simply retreat farther into her shell. If they continue to be pushy, Jennifer will interrupt and suggest that they try a different tact. If they continue to push after that, the run is over and Jennifer will throw them out. Anyone who has her as a contact will lose her.

Details

Melina can relate the following. How you present this info is up to you.

1. Thomas was her twin. She felt him die. It was very slow and very painful. She thinks she heard laughter.
2. Thomas was killed by a man, she does not know how she knows, but she is certain of it.
3. Thomas was a courier for Knight Errant.
4. Thomas lived at 4568 Sullivan Drive #454 in Tacoma.
5. Thomas had no enemies as far as Melina knows.
6. The name of the Investigating Officer for Lone Star is Harry Bosh; he was very nice but did not tell her much. Jennifer has his card.
7. When She went to identify the body, Thomas' eyes were missing. They had been gouged out.
8. The Doctor who did the autopsy was very nice. She asked about Thomas being magical. Her name was Dr. Pat Cromwell.
9. Thomas was killed two days ago. His body was found floating in the Sound.

- If the runners decide to go to the apartment go to: “Sublet Anyone?”
- If the runners contact the Lone Star officer, go to “Meeting the Star”
- If the runners go see the coroner, go to “Is There A Doctor In The House”

Scene One: Sublet Anyone?

Tell It To Them Straight: *The address for the apartment of Thomas Kyle turns out to be a crumbling brownstone in one of the worse parts of Tacoma. The aroma coming from the factories is almost suffocating. Inside the lobby, things are not much better. The lights are flickering, the floor crunches as you step through debris and roaches. At the far end of the lobby is an open elevator shaft, cables dangling uselessly. There is also a door marked EXIT that leads to a flight of rickety stairs. Near the stairs is the chalk outline of a body that has not rubbed off. The bloodstains have apparently been cleaned up. On the 4th floor is a heavy steel security door marked 454. Beside it, countersunk into the wall is a state-of-the-art security panel complete with keypad and retinal scanner. There is also a seal on the door bearing the Lone Star emblem. It states that the apartment is part of a Lone Star investigation and therefore off-limits.*

Biz

If any of the players check the astral, they will note that there is a watcher (force 1) shaped like a star, guarding the front door. If they open the door without dealing with it, Lone Star will be on site in 15 minutes. Note: If they have the password from Harry Bosh, it will assume they are official).

Opening the Door will take an Electronics (6) test or a decker to hack an Orange (7) host.

Once they get the door open they are greeted by a small dog, which is very happy to see them. The apartment is considered high lifestyle. There are nova hot music and trid chips, real wine, and some old books. The apartment itself is clean with the exception of the dog droppings that ubiquitously litter the floor.

The important thing for the team to find in the searching is the invitation to the showing of the work of Jannos Kolchak at the Bellevue Art Gallery entitled Rebirth. It is to be held next Friday. The invitation is sandwiched between two books and will take an Intelligence (6) Test to find.

Details

There is not much to go wrong here. They could get stuck at the door (barrier rating 20) and they could get stuck duking it out with the Star. Melina will have the codes for the door. If they are silly enough to take on Lone Star, let them.

- If the runners decide to go to the Gallery, go to: “How Much Is That Ink Blot In The Window?”
- If the runners contact the Lone Star officer, go to “Meeting the Star”
- If the runners go see the coroner, go to “Is There A Doctor In The House”

Scene Two: Meeting the Star

Tell It To Them Straight: *When you call the number on the card, a gruff voice picks up and says “Lone Star, DPI (Department of Paranormal Investigation), Harry Bosh speaking.” He agrees to meet you at the Grey Line bar by the docks in an hour. The bar is dark, and the runners will be shown to a darker, back room. “Since you are here I can only assume you were the ones who contacted me regarding the death of Thomas Kyle,” speaks a gruff voice. A face appears out of the darkness and becomes slightly clearer; in a moment; it is of an older dwarf. When one looks into his eyes you can tell that he has seen some strange things in his life. From his looks, you can also tell that he is a Lone Star cop. “I assume you are, umm... persons who live their lives free of the Law’s entanglements? Sometimes that is a benefit--what can I do for you?”*

Biz

Let the runners pitch their case, it should be fairly easy to convince Bosh to talk (Negotiation (3)), he is fairly desperate for help on this case. However, he needs to be convinced that the runners will see it through. If they can convince him of this, then he will relate the following:

“Well, I have seen a lot in my career, but this is the second time that I have seen something like this. The perp is taking the eyes out of his victims’ heads. So far, Thomas is the fourth victim, but Lone Star will never admit to the fact. I tell you this only to let you know that I can also use you help to end these killings. About five years ago there was another string of murders; we caught the guy that did it. Yes, before you ask, I have checked--he is still at the Sanitarium.

“We can’t seem to draw any type of connection to the crimes other than the fact that the victim loses body

parts and also that their hearts have been replaced by doves. We have yet to figure out the connection to the body part loss and the doves,” the dwarf pauses for a moment. “I really don’t know much about the doves, you will have to ask the coroner.”

The only other thing I can tell you is that this case is going to take a long time to be solved, if it ever is. The fraggin’ thing is a jurisdictional nightmare; I have been told to lay off until all the red tape and litigation is handled. Lone Star has the enforcement contract for the city and thus has jurisdiction. However, KE is claiming they should investigate because one of their own is involved and are suing the Star to get it. The drekking FBI wants the case because of the patterns in the crime scene and to other cases. I have also heard that Interpol is going to be sending some representatives as well. It looks like you guys are the only hope of getting redemption for the victims. Good luck.

Details

The things that Detective Bosh can relate are.

1. The man in the Sanitarium, the Snomish Shiawase Psychiatric Research and Development Center, Derek Von Leek, killed six people in three weeks exactly five years ago. He removed the eyes of his victims.
2. Bosh is on the case because he handled the case 5 years ago, despite his being DPI. Although he is not convinced that there is not a paranormal angle here. Lone Star wants to keep this as quiet as possible.
3. The victims so far are:

John Doe, Elven, who was found on the docks near SeaTac. His neck was broken. And his eyes were not removed but they were cybered. His hands had been removed. He was suspected of being a shadowrunner. He had no SIN and had a Rigger jack. A picture can be provided. Est. 4/15/63 (Easter, approx. 2 weeks ago)

Dr. Tonshiko Hana, Japanese female, PhDs in art restoration and Renaissance painting. Eyes removed, almost lovingly. Her body was found in her studio on campus. Room 131 of the Hoffhiemer Building. Est. 4/19/63 (approx 4 days after first murder)

Abbot Rosenthal THmd. Registered mage. Blind, no corrective cyberware. Eyes intact, but his ears were removed. He was found in his home, which doubled as his office. 6363 Windmere in the Elven District, Downtown. Est. 4/26/63 (1 week after 2nd killing)

Thomas Kyle, Bonded Courier Knight Errant, eyes removed. Was killed in the lobby of his

apartment building. 4568 Sullivan Drive, #454, Tacoma. Est.5/9/63 (two weeks after third killing)

“Oh yeah, one more thing, if you have to enter any crime scenes, sing a few bars of the song Yellow Rose of Texas. It will let the watchers know you are official.”

- If the runners decide to go to the apartment, go to: “Sublet Anyone?”
- If the runners go see the coroner, go to “Is There A Doctor In The House?”
- If the runners go to the gallery, go to “How Much Is That Ink Blot In The Window?”
- If the runners go to the sanitarium, go to “May I Fit You For A Straight Jacket, Sir?”
- If the runners go to the docks, go to Legwork
- If the runners go to the University, go to “Inside the Ivory Tower”
- If the runners go to the mage, go to “Ears To You”

Scene Three: Is There A Doctor In The House?

Tell It To Them Straight: *You enter the morgue about midnight and the place is quiet as a tomb. An antiseptic smell greets you as you walk down the harshly lit corridor; your footsteps ring like peals of thunder. As you approach the security desk, a bored cop looks up from the vid he is watching. “Can I help you,” he asks, giving you a dubious look. Just about any explanation will do to get past this guy. After a few minutes of conversation, the guard picks up the phone, speaks for a few seconds, and buzzes you through the heavy metal doors.*

The dissecting room smells of dead flesh and formaldehyde. The stench is not one that many people are use to, but the party is.

Bent over a large troll body, which has his chest cavity open, is a human female with her nose almost in the opened cavity. Without even looking up she says, “Are you all lost?? Not many people come down here...” With that, her head rises up and the party sees a lady in her forty’s with a slight white streak in her raven hair.

“So I asked what brings you down here, I’m busy,” she says with a slight disgust in her voice. She goes over to another area, leaving the table and grabbing a porcelain cup. “Hopefully a dead body is not bothering you; it is what I mostly see down here in the dungeon,” she states in between sips of coffee.

Biz

After the players introduce themselves, Dr. Kromwell will stand there looking at them as if waiting for something. The players will need to make a Negotiation test to earn her trust. If they walked in cold, without an appointment, the target is 8. If they have an appointment, the target is 6. If they mention Bosh or have him set it up, the target number is dropped by 3.

“I’m Dr. Kromwell, but you knew that. So you are looking into the strange deaths. You would think that after doing this for 20 years that I have seen it all. Now I have to see it twice. I don’t know that I can help you with whatever you are looking for,” she tells you, looking you over.

After some talking with the party...she will warm up to them slightly.

There are two subjects that she will talk about and the case 5 years ago.

The current murders:

“There is not much to tell; all four victims were killed by having their necks broken after the body parts were removed. Whoever is doing this is incredibly strong. Furthermore, the victims were all alive when the parts were harvested. The perp was very careful to take them while doing as little damage as possible. The most distinguishing aspect of this case, however, is the fact that when the chest cavity is opened, the heart of the victim is somehow magically transformed into a dove--a white dove. Bosh warned me that this case was similar to the one 5 years ago, so I was not as freaked out as last time, but it still scared the crap out of me. We have a couple of mages on standby for the next one to come in. The other interesting fact in this case is that each victim has had several pints of blood missing. The brass upstairs thinks we are looking at a vamp that does not bite. Bosh and I think it is something else entirely; what--I cannot tell you.”

The case 5 years ago:

“There is not much to tell. I was working late like tonight; I was an assistant coroner then. We got a series of stiffs in--their eyes had all been removed with almost surgical precision. The case baffled the cops. I started the autopsy, noting the body marks, defensive wounds, and cause of death, standard procedure really. When I cut into the chest cavity this mass of spiders boiled out; big hairy ones, little black ones, all kinds. I completely freaked--I could not step into another lab for days.

“Now it has started all over again in a strange way,” states Kay, with a sort of puzzled look on her

face. “Yeah it feels the same but I know that it can’t be the same.

“I hope that you are able to stop whoever is doing this, if last time is any indication it will start to get sloppier and messier. I was suppose to be in Miami now, instead I got to wait it out. Lone Star wants as few people to know about this as possible.”

Details

Dr. Kromwell is more at home dealing with the dead than with real like people. So it shows when dealing with the runners. Not much can go wrong here. Dr. Kromwell does not have a lot of information other than what has been stated. If she starts to feel threatened in any way she will not hesitate to hit a panic button, which will bring a Lone Star response within 30 seconds.

- If the runners decide to go to the apartment, go to: “Sublet Anyone?”
- If the runners go to the gallery, go to “How Much Is That Ink Blot In The Window?”
- If the runners go to the sanitarium, go to “May I Fit You For A Straight Jacket, Sir?”
- If the runners go to the docks, go to Legwork
- If the runners go to the University, go to “Inside the Ivory Tower”
- If the runners go to the mage, go to “Ears To You”

Scene Four: Inside The Ivory Tower

Tell It To Them Straight: *You are able to find Hoffhiemer hall without a problem. Campus Security is a joke; they don’t even know that there are several heavily armed thugs getting ready to invade a crime scene right under their very noses. As you approach the studio, you see the now familiar seal across the door. “This room is sealed by order of Lone Star. Do not open. Violators will be prosecuted to the fullest extent of the law.” A maglock has been placed under the seal. (It is a rating 3 maglock)*

Once the group has gained entry, read the following.

Once you enter the studio, you see the chalk outline of the body. Blood has soaked into the wood surrounding the body. It looks like the legs of the victim had been broken. A large painting stands on an easel under a glass skylight. Besides the painting is a wheeled table with chemicals, brushes and paints. The painting itself looks like someone has smeared feces on it.

Biz

Have the players make an Intelligence (4) test to search. The player with the most successes will realize that there is not a phone here, or a computer, or books or papers or anything but paints.

Details

There are a couple of things that could go wrong here. First, if the runners don't sing Yellow Rose of Texas, the watcher in astral space will alert Lone Star. Response time is 5 minutes with 2 patrol units. Second, they could not realize that he has an office elsewhere on campus.

Both the feces and blood are too old to provide a material link.

- If the runners decide to go to the apartment, go to: "Sublet Anyone?"
- If the runners go see the coroner, go to "Is There A Doctor In The House"
- If the runners go to the gallery, go to "How Much Is That Ink Blot In The Window?"
- If the runners go to the sanitarium, go to "May I Fit You For A Straight Jacket, Sir?"
- If the runners go to the docks, go to Legwork
- If the runners go to the Office, go to "Office Hours"

Scene Five: Office Hours

Tell It To Them Straight: *You have found Dr. Hana's office finally. If you had to talk to one more snottose freshman you would have gone on a homicidal rampage. However, you are here and once again confronted by the ubiquitous maglock (Rating 3). However, there is no evidence of a Lone Star seal.*

Once you are through the door, you know that you are too late. Someone beat you here. There are stacks of books, papers everywhere; you even think that the mound in the corner is a computer. As you look around, you start to see a method to the mess.

Biz

It will take some looking but there are some clues to be found here. Have the group make a Perception (8) test. The more successes, the less time it will take to find. No successes result in it taking 2 hours to dig through everything.

At the end of their search the runners will find:

1. Several papers with drops of blood on them.

2. There is also a desktop computer, with no decker jacks.
3. Various bottles of paints and brushes.
4. About 150 books in various formats and subjects.
5. A tray of half eaten sushi that looks like it is ready to get up and find the nearest ocean.
6. Several small canvases with messages painted on them. One looks like a shopping list, there is another with some math, there is one found by the telecom with the message reading "Jannos brought the most interesting painting. Must be a lost Renaissance Masterpiece. Colors so vibrant, unlike anything I have seen before. Must call Abbot and gloat, I found it!!!"

Details

About the only thing that can go wrong here is that the players take too long in the office. Every 15 minutes, roll 3 dice with a target # of 8. If a success is rolled, that will mean someone has tipped off security and they are on the way. Use the troll bouncer archetype from the Contacts book.

If someone tries to hack the computer, have them attempt a Computer (5) test. Deckers do not get to use their control pool. The system is that old. Success will indicate that they have gotten in, not that there is much here. The last entry is dated about 3 years ago; they are old lecture notes for a class on Magic and Art. About the most useful thing they will find is the address file that contains the address and number for Abbot Rosenthal--but they have that already.

- If the runners decide to go to the apartment, go to: "Sublet Anyone?"
- If the runners go see the coroner, go to "Is There A Doctor In The House"
- If the runners go to the gallery, go to "How Much Is That Ink Blot In The Window?"
- If the runners go to the sanitarium, go to "May I Fit You For A Straight Jacket, Sir?"
- If the runners go to the docks, go to Legwork
- If the runners go to the mage, go to "Ears To You"

Scene Six: Ears To You

Tell It To Them Straight: *The home and office of Abbot Rosenthal is located in the Elven district, one of the northern most sections of Downtown Seattle. You find his building without trouble; it is an old ivy-covered Victorian townhouse. Two stone lions are out front. As you mount the steps, the ever-present maglock and Lone Star seal are there. This is getting tedious.*

Once the runners enter the house [maglock (3)]”

It looks like Dr. Hana’s office--except without the organizational skills. The place is a mess; it looks like the proverbial bull got loose. There is broken glass, books ripped in half, the Trid is smashed, and the stuffing has been ripped out of the furniture. The most disturbing thing here is the chalk outline; the body is outlined over by the couch, and the head is outlined in the hall. Oddly enough, there is very little in the way of blood.

Biz

A Perception (8) test is required here. About all there is for the runners to find is a chip with voice-only recordings. After listening to it, the runners can deduce that Abbot was working on a book called “Of Magic and Painting: A Pre-Awakened Discovery.” The last entry on the chip is “heard from Hana about a new painting one of her students found. I wish I could have examined it. Sounds like it might be the painting I need to finish this book. I finally tracked down the artist, I will see the painting tonight!”

Details

Once again the Yellow Rose of Texas must be sung or the watcher taken care of. This neighborhood has a security rating of A. Lone Star responds in 1 minute, including a mage and Fast Response Team. (See Lone Star book).

- If the runners decide to go to the apartment, go to: “Sublet Anyone?”
- If the runners go see the coroner, go to “Is There A Doctor In The House”
- If the runners go to the gallery, go to “How Much Is That Ink Blot In The Window?”
- If the runners go to the sanitarium, go to “May I Fit You For A Straight Jacket, Sir?”
- If the runners go to the docks, go to Legwork
- If the runners go to the Office, go to “Office Hours”

Scene Seven: May I Fit You For A Straight Jacket, Sir?

Tell It To Them Straight: *The drive out to Snohomish is a long one. You hope this guy can help; it should be interesting pumping an insane serial killer for information. As you pull up to the Shiawase*

Psychiatric Research & Development Center, you expect something out of one of those horror trids, but instead see a modern looking building that would not be out of place anywhere in corporate Seattle. The familiar chain link fence, the checkpoints, the armed guards, it is all refreshing and none of them will require you to sing Yellow Rose of Texas to get in.

As you enter the R&D facility, you have to pass through a large ceramic arch which you are fairly certain is a weapons scanner of some kind. Of course the sign beside the arch, NO WEAPONS OF ANY KIND PERMITTED PAST THIS POINT, kind of gives it away.

The sanitarium is a nice place. It is well kept, bright and sunny and seems to be fairly busy. A young elven nurse greets you at the front desk “Yes, can I help you folk(s)” she greets them. “Well, he doesn’t get many visitors here at the home. I will go see if he is accepting visitors. I will get him and bring him to the day room,” she speaks in a very factual manner. A troll attendant leads the party to the room. He takes you down two hallways to get to the day room. Five minutes after you arrive, the nurse wheels in the old man that you came to see.

Aldolfus Van Leech is bent over in his wheelchair and his arms seem to be bound around his stomach. Although, there doesn’t seem to be anything holding them there.

Biz

While he is here, Aldolfus is constantly in motion, rocking back and forth. If he is astrally perceived (Int. (4/8), see notes about background count below) he will have a hazy aura, but is not magically active. It looks like something had played with it, but not destroyed it.

While the party talks with Aldofus, he will have a glazed look on his eyes and babble nonsense. He does have a few moments of sanity, and will give the party bits of information.

Interspersed with the nonsense, that he randomly spouts, He can tell them

1. The eyes are the windows to the souls
2. Used to be strong, so strong
3. Art Therapy is fun
4. My Muse is back but has chosen another
5. In the end the spiders get us all

After a little time, he will shut down and become very incoherent. He will rock more; if pushed too much he will lash out into the air, NOT at a party member.

Details

About the biggest problem that the runners will face here is making a scene. This place is defended by corp.

guards complete with automatic weapons. They will not allow anyone with weapons, cyber or otherwise, to enter.

The arch is a MAD (Magnetic Anomaly Detector) (Neo-Anarchist Guide to Real Life) Rating 14.

If the players want to start a fight, 14 guards will defend till back up arrives.

If the players want to speak with a doctor, they will be escorted to Dr. Frencler, who will answer questions to the best of his ability. The important points are:

1. Van Leech is never leaving
2. His art therapy works are sold occasionally
3. His work is very dark and violent, but also very precise. He paints like someone from the Renaissance period.
4. He has acute arachnophobia
5. He is 35 years old.

If the mages astrally perceive this place, it looks like a combination of Salvador Dali meets Roger Rabbit meets the background count (+4 to all astral tests and spellcasting) from hell.

- If the runners decide to go to the apartment, go to: “Sublet Anyone?”
- If the runners go see the coroner, go to “Is There A Doctor In The House”
- If the runners go to the gallery, go to “How Much Is That Ink Blot In The Window?”
- If the runners go to the docks, go to Legwork
- If the runners go to the Office, go to “Office Hours”

Scene Eight: How Much Is That Inkblot In The Window?

Tell It To Them Straight: *The Gallery is set in a quiet area of Downtown. The door is closed and locked when the party arrives. The glass is dark so that you cannot see in. A much larger maglock is keeping the door shut. (Rating 7). Once you enter the main gallery, pictures are cut and strewn all over the place.*

The inside of the gallery looks as if someone was looking frantically for something. Many of the paintings have been either cut and sliced or ripped from the wall.

Biz

As the party searches the gallery several perception tests are needed. The first test (9) is to notice the small droplets of blood on the black marble floor. They lead to the back of the Gallery, the storage and work areas. The second test (6) is to find that the back door has

been burst open. The door is still locked--it just has a large hole in it. The third test (9) is to find the pocket secretary in the mess of the back room. The party will also find a man who has been torn limb from limb. A Forensics (4) check will tell that he has been dead less than an hour.

If the party uses magic to assess the scene, they will feel the rage of Jannos and the torture of Cabot, the gallery owner. They can search the gallery to try and find more information.

In Cabot's pocket secretary they will find the address of all his clients, critics and artists. Also is an invoice from Knight Errant for the delivery of some paintings from Jannos Kolchak. The other file on the pocket secretary is plans for a showing next week of the art of Jannos Kolchak, entitled “Rebirth.”

Details

It should be fairly obvious to the players that Lone Star has not yet been here. In fact, they will arrive 10 minutes after the players arrive, with an FRT unit (see Lone Star book). If a player gets the idea to go through all the paints stored back here to see if anything is missing, a Perception (12) test will tell them that everything is here except 1 painting -- #48484 by Jannos Kolchak. Of course, that will take a good amount of time.

A simple Computer (3) test will show Kolchak's address.

- If the runners go see the coroner, go to “Is There A Doctor In The House”
- If the runners go to the docks, go to Legwork
- If the runners go to the Office, go to “Office Hours”
- If the runners go to Kolchak's apt. go to “At Death's Door”

Scene Nine: At Death's Door

Tell It To Them Straight: *Jannos Kolchak's apartment is in a quiet section of Redmond. As you drive the streets, you see no evidence of gang activity. A most unusual thing for this district. As you approach the dilapidated building, you note that the place is on the verge of collapse. Inside you think you hear someone shouting.*

Biz

At this point the group needs to make a Perception (4) test--if they succeed they hear “*Why are you hounding me, WHY??!!? It matters not, you will join my muse soon.*” Players with enhanced hearing will also hear the

sickening sound of bone snapping and a muffled scream.

The door is locked but rather flimsy, barrier rating 6.

When the party breaks down the door, they see Detective Bosh suspended from the ceiling like some perverse marionette. He is gagged and bleeding heavily. His left leg is dangling at a funny angle. Below him are several paint cans slowly collecting blood. Hanging on the left wall, illuminated by candles is a very disturbing looking painting. In front of the painting on a small table are jars of some liquid with various body parts in them: a pair of ears, a hand, and a lot of eyes. On the other side of the room is a stack of boxed paintings and an easel with an unfinished painting upon it.

When the party crosses the threshold of the room, have everyone make a Perception (20) check. Anyone with success will see the painting on the altar, glow briefly and then fade. *Where the colors were once vibrant and shimmering, they seem dull and lifeless now. The artist screams, "My Muse!! Where have you gone, where are you??" He whirls and looks at you with murder in his eye. "It is because of you, she is gone, and you will bring her back when I cut out your eyes!!" He charges.*

Roll initiative and begin Combat.

Details

If the party waits longer to enter the room, Detective Bosh will be considerably worse for wear. At least one eye will be missing.

Kolchack is magically enhanced by the painting. Now that the spirit of the painting has left, that magic will start to fade. For every round after the first 2, drop all of his stats by 1 until you hit his natural limit. After the 4th round of combat, Kolchack will realize he cannot win and starts trying to escape. If he gets out of the house, he will disappear. See **Cast of Characters** for stats.

If the players win, and search the house, they will find in another room the bodies of the gangers (the Union Jacks) stacked like cordwood. They will also find Jannos' Diary. Which pieces together the whole thing. From buying the painting from the elven smuggler to the visions and voices, to grabbing the detective. They will also find a receipt from Knight Errant, for the pick up of a collection of paintings.

Scene Ten: Missing Melina

Note: This is an optional encounter to be run at the GM's Discretion. It can be put in anywhere.

Tell It To Them Straight: *You are deep into the investigation when your phone rings. On the other end is Jennifer Richardson. "Melina is insisting that she needs to go to Thomas' apartment and pack it up. I cannot reason with her, and if I try to hold her here I am afraid that she will hurt herself. I need you to come back and escort her to the apartment. I will keep her here as long as I can."*

As you get in sight of the stately Bellevue manor, you see a black Ford Americar speeding away in the other direction. It is being pursued by two wolves.

Biz

Have whoever is driving make a handling check (3) to turn around, unless of course they slow down. The Ford Americar is still in sight. Each driver must make a drive test (4) to keep it in sight. An acceleration test will be necessary to catch it. See rigger rules for details.

Details

The FBI has just grabbed Melina. It should not be too hard to catch the car. Once they do, 3 men in black suits and shades will get out with Melina, one will hustle her off down the block to cover while the other two provide covering fire.

See Cast of Characters for stats. If the players have trouble with these guys, have the werewolves show up and help out.

Picking Up The Pieces

Tell It To Them Straight: *Melina is grateful for what you have done. Now she knows and can start to grieve. Jennifer is happy because Melina is going to get better. In fact, she is so happy she gives you a 10% bonus.*

Remember the salary cap. No player can make more than 100,000 nuyen.

If the players want to fence anything they took from the dead peoples' stuff, they can get another 130,000 nuyen. That is including the painting of the now late Jannos Kolchak, which will appreciate in value.

The End

Karma Summary

To award karma for this adventure, add up the values for the objectives accomplished. Then assign the

discretionary roleplaying experience award. The roleplaying award should be given for consistent character portrayal and contribution to the fun of the game. You can award different roleplaying amounts to different characters.

Award the total value (objectives plus roleplaying) to each character.

Defeating Kolchak	1
Saving Det. Bosh	1
Good deductive reasoning	1
Total karma for objectives	3
Discretionary roleplaying award	1-3
Total possible karma	6

Other Awards: If the runners manage to rescue Detective Harry Bosh, they get him as a Level 1 Contact. Make sure they note that he is with the *Department of Paranormal Investigations*.

Loot Summary

Player characters may keep items from the scenario that are listed on the treasure list below or which meet the following conditions:

1. The item must be non-magical and specifically listed in the text of the adventure (e.g armor on foes). If it is not listed in the text, the characters cannot keep it. Items of this nature can be sold for 50% of book value, or recorded on a log sheet.
2. Animals, followers, elementals, spirits, henchmen, and so forth (any living being, basically) may not be kept from a scenario for any reason unless the treasure summary lists the being specifically. It is okay for the player characters to form relationships with NPCs, but these will not be certified and cannot bring material benefit to the character.
3. Petty Theft is against the law, and beneath professional Shadowrunners that work for Claudia.

Any item retained according to these rules, which does not have a certificate, will not ever have a certificate issued for it.

The campaign staff reserves the right to take away any item or money acquired for things it later finds unreasonable but which were allowed at the time.

If the players want to fence anything they took from the dead peoples' stuff, they can get another 130,000 nuyen. That is including the painting of the now late Jannos Kolchak, which will appreciate in value.

Legwork

All target numbers are 4 unless otherwise stated:

John Doe: Dock Workers, Shadowrunners, Claudia

- 1 – Know him? Ya, he comes in every couple of months, always looking for a deal.
- 2 – Yeah, he runs a souped up boat. Moves things up and down the coast.
- 3 – His name is Hanson; he does a lot of contract work with the Imperial Marines down in Frisco.
- 4 – Yeah, he was at the docks ‘bout 3 weeks ago. Said his buyer stood him up. Wanted to unload some fancy painting. I guess he found someone...

Detective Harry Bosh: Lone Star, Claudia, Mr. Johnson, Street types

- 1 – One cop is the same as another, chummer
- 2 – I’ve dealt with him once or twice, not a bad guy for a Star.
- 3 – Bosh, yeah, I know him--he is usually in trouble with the Star. Won’t let go of a case until it is done. Very unconventional guy.

Thomas Kyle: Corps (esp. Ares), Lone Star,

- 1 – Good guy, hard worker, always going somewhere.
- 2 – Yeah, he is a bonded courier for Knight Errant.
- 3 – He is a trusted employee. Usually ends up getting the big-ticket items.

Aldolphus Van Leech: artists, psychiatrists, Lone Star, Claudia

- 1 – Isn’t he the guy that shot Kennedy?
- 2 – I remember him; he was a painter about 6 years ago, very successful too.
- 3 – A painter and serial killer went around taking out people’s eyes and mixing their blood into the paint. A real nutter. I heard he just got out too.

Tonshiko Hana: students, faculty, museum curator, artists, fixer

- 1 – Some visiting professor over at UDUB.
- 2 – She is very popular with the students. No, really, the History of Art Restoration is such a great class.
- 3 – She teaches at the University and accepts commissions to restore damaged paintings. I hear there is a waiting list for her services.
- 4 – I know she is looking for an old, old painting. Its called Visions of Heaven and Hell. She has this theory that certain paintings are magically active.

Abbot Rosenthal: Mages, artists, Talismongers

- 1 – Some blind guy lives with the elves.
- 2 – He is a mage, used to be fairly powerful. Now, he just buys paintings.
- 3 – He is an artist--he paints astral space. He’s also working on a book.
- 4 – Spends a lot of time at the museum looking at the Masterpieces. What a blind guy looks at, I don’t know.

Jannos Kolchak: Artists, Fixers, Claudia

- 1 – Yea he was on that old 2D vidshow. The Nightstalker or something.
- 2 – He was an artist who hit it big about five years ago, then dropped off the face of the earth.
- 3 – I think he has some new stuff showing soon.
- 4 – Yeah, he has a new series of paintings showing at the La Galleria, Downtown. Pretty Ritzy.
- 5 – He paints on the condition of the human and metahuman soul with a theme of redemption running through it.

Cast of Characters

Jannos Kolchak, Human

Artist/Physical Adept

Body: 3 (14)
Quickness: 3 (8)
Strength: 2(16)
Charisma: 6(2)
Intelligence: 4
Willpower: 6(4)
Essence: 6(1)
Magic: 0
Reaction: 6
Initiative: 6+1d6 (3d6)
Combat Pool: 8
Karma Pool: 3 + Average Karma Pool of Party

Note: all enhanced attribute will raise or lower to normal levels at the rate of 1 per round.

Skills

Painting: 6
Etiquette 5
Street Fighting: 1 (6)
Negotiation 5
Armed combat / Scalpel: 5

Powers

Improved Reflexes
Killing Hands (M)
Magic Resistance 4
Mystic armor 4
Rapid Healing 4
Ignore Pain (8 boxes)

Note: all of these powers are granted by the painting. They will dissipate in the 4th round of combat.

Gear

Credstick with 100 nuyen
Scalpel
Brushes
Paint

FBI GOONS

Weapon Specialist archetype

Body: 5
Quickness: 6
Strength: 4
Charisma: 3
Intelligence: 6
Willpower: 6
Essence: 4.15
Reaction: 6(7)
Initiative: 7+2d6

Gear

Boosted Reflexes 2
Cybereyes: Rangefinder, Flare Comp, Thermo, Mag 3
Smartlink 2
AK98s (SA, BF, FA 8M, 38clip)
Regular ammo, offensive mini grenades (10S)
Ruger Thunderbolts (BF, 12S, 12C)(Smartlink2)
No recoil 1st burst, +4 2nd burst
Defiance T-250 (SA, 10S, 4 mag)
Body armor (4/1)

Skills

Biotech (first aid) 1/3
Aikido 4
Etiquette: 3
Pistols: 6
Assault Rifles: 6
Stealth (sneaking) 3/5
Thrown Weapons: 4

Note: the Ford Americar has 3 points of armor.
Inside is a Laser Microphone (r6), Microrecorder,
and Camera.